

things you do. If you are going to blog maybe the e-mail newsletter should reference the blog? Or be replaced by it?

7. Who's the blogger?

The Department of Corporate Communications does not blog. No organizational unit does. People working there do. You of course have to find people that want to, that wish nothing else but to, blog. In most real life cases I have seen this has actually been the starting point, and those people have been the advocates for the blog in the process we're talking about here.

8. Make a decision on all aspects, features of blogs

Will you allow comments? Will they be moderated by you? Is Trackback a feature to offer? What RSS versions? Atom, too? Categories or not? A blogroll, maybe? Make sure you know what all these small peculiarities of blogs are and if you think they will help you. And then you need to take some more important decisions. What will you write about and what is absolutely impossible to write about? Will you for example link to competitors? Tip: If you say no to this, start at #2 again...

9. Choose which tool to use

There are a lot of tools to compare, but if you have done #8 you know what to look for.

10. Create a blogging policy

Again, if you have done #8 you know what to put in this - you can get some guidance from others (see the web page of these 14 steps for links).

11. Make sure the blogger(s) know blogging

Blogging is a skill. Not a very unique one, but a skill. The blogger must first of all know how to write, and he or she should know how the blogosphere works.

12. Launch quietly

Ideas and fine plans are one thing. But how does it turn out? Are